ACMI Properties CRM/Hub: Hosting budget

Prepared for approval. Figures are monthly estimates in US dollars for a team of about ten people.

What we are asking for

The CRM currently runs on one laptop. Nobody else on the team can use it, and it stops when the laptop is off or asleep. To make it available to the whole team, we need to host it on Google Cloud under the acmigroup.com Workspace account. That requires a Google Cloud billing account, which means a company card on file. We expect the cost to be about $30 to $45 a month, roughly $360 to $540 a year.

Google Cloud has not been charged anything so far. The project exists, but billing is switched off, so nothing here has been spent.

Monthly cost

Service	What it does	Est. per month
Cloud Run	Runs the CRM web application	$0 to $10
Cloud SQL (PostgreSQL)	Stores all CRM data	$26 to $30
Database storage and backups	Disk space and nightly copies	$2 to $5
Secret Manager	Holds passwords and keys	Under $1
Artifact Registry	Stores the built application	Under $1
Cloud Scheduler	Triggers the 15-minute mail and calendar sync	$0 to $1
Total		**About $30 to $45**

What each item is and why we need it

Cloud Run

Cloud Run is where the CRM application itself runs. Google starts it when someone opens the site and shuts it down when nobody is using it, so we pay only for the time it is actually working. At our size, most months fall inside Google's free allowance. The usual cost is between zero and ten dollars. The first page load after a quiet period can take a few extra seconds. If that bothers the team, we can keep one copy always running for a few dollars more.

Cloud SQL for PostgreSQL

This is the database. It holds the companies, people, deals, emails, tasks, meetings, documents and land-search parcels. Today that data sits in a single file on the laptop, which is 264 MB and cannot be shared safely between several people at once. Cloud SQL is a managed database: Google patches it, keeps it running and takes automatic backups, so we do not need anyone to administer a server. It is the largest line in this budget. We would start on the small shared-core size, which is about $26 a month, and move up only if the CRM feels slow.

Database storage and backups

The database is billed for disk space and for the backup copies Google keeps. We plan to reserve 10 GB, which covers the current data with room for the land-search parcels. Disk is about 17 cents per GB per month and backups about 8 cents. Together that is a few dollars. The disk grows automatically if we need more.

Secret Manager

Secret Manager stores the sensitive values the CRM needs: the Google sign-in key, the Django security key and the Anthropic API key. They are kept here instead of in the code or on a laptop. Google charges a few cents per secret, and our handful costs under a dollar.

Artifact Registry

When we update the CRM, Google builds it into a package and stores it here, so Cloud Run can start the exact version we released and we can roll back to an earlier one. The package is small. Storage is about 10 cents per GB and the first half GB is free.

Cloud Scheduler

Cloud Scheduler is the clock. Every 15 minutes it tells the CRM to pull in new Gmail and Google Calendar entries. Today that job is a Windows scheduled task on the laptop, which only works while the laptop is on and signed in. Google gives three scheduled jobs free each month, so this should cost nothing.

Services we use that cost nothing extra

Google sign-in, the Calendar connection and the Gmail connection are all part of the Workspace accounts ACMI already pays for. Restricting sign-in to acmigroup.com addresses is a setting, not a purchase. Cloud Build, which deploys each update from GitHub, has a free monthly allowance that we are unlikely to exceed. GitHub's private repository is free for our use.

AI summaries: which model and where it runs

The CRM can write a short summary at the top of each company and person page, covering the history of the relationship and the open questions. This feature is built but switched off, because it needs an account with an AI provider. The AI always runs in the cloud. The CRM server on Cloud Run sends the text to the provider and shows the answer, so nothing runs on a laptop.

The usage cost is not included in the monthly table above, because it depends on how often the team opens records. A summary is a small request, typically a fraction of a cent to a few cents each. We expect a few dollars a month for ten people, and we will report the real figure after the first month.

There are three ways to set it up:

Option	How it works	Pros and cons
Claude through the Anthropic API	The CRM calls Anthropic directly with an API key kept in Secret Manager.	Already built and tested in the CRM. Fastest to switch on. Billed separately by Anthropic, with a spending limit we set in their console.
Claude through Google Vertex AI	The same Claude models, called through Google Cloud. No separate key.	Usage appears on the Google Cloud bill, and data stays in our Google project. Needs small code changes. Availability of a specific model by

		region must be checked in Vertex's Model Garden.
Google Gemini through Vertex AI	Google's own model, on the Google Cloud bill.	Single bill and sign-in. The AI code would need to be rewritten and the summaries re-checked, since the CRM was built and tested against Claude.

Recommendation: start with the Anthropic API directly, because it works today, and set a monthly spending limit. If the team prefers one Google bill, move to Claude on Vertex AI afterwards. We would only choose Gemini if a side-by-side test on about 20 real companies shows better summaries. Anthropic states that Vertex AI supports the same options as its own API, but we have not yet confirmed that Vertex rates match Anthropic's list prices or that our model is offered in our region.

Other costs outside Google Cloud

The team would reach the CRM at hub.acmigroup.com. That is a subdomain of the domain ACMI already owns, so it needs one DNS record and no new purchase, and Google adds no charge for it.

How we keep the bill from growing

We will set a budget alert at $50 a month so that Google emails us before spending drifts. We will check the first month's invoice against this page and update the estimates with real numbers.

Where the estimates come from

These are estimates, not quotes. The Cloud SQL price comes from third-party price trackers listing the small shared-core PostgreSQL instance at about $26 a month in the central US region. The other rates are from memory of Google's published price lists and have not been checked against the live pages. Before this is final, the figures should be confirmed in Google's pricing calculator at cloud.google.com/products/calculator.

Decision needed

Approval to create a Google Cloud billing account for the acmigroup.com organization and link it to the CRM project, with a company card, an expected spend of $30 to $45 a month, and an alert